

Committee: United Nations Human Rights Council

Topic: The Question of Combating Child Labor and Child Trafficking

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Introduction

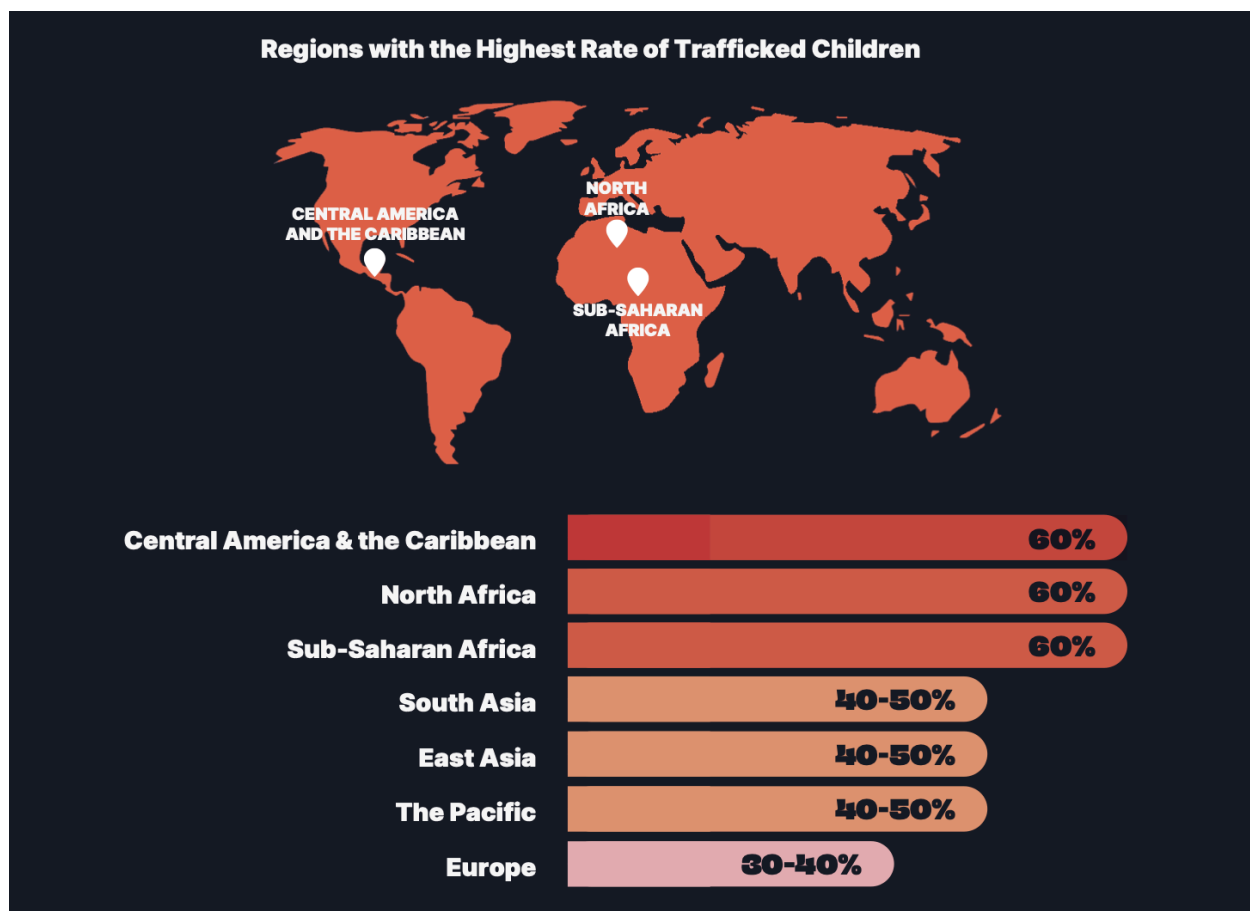
Since children's rights have been considered a vital concern for centuries, they have progressively evolved and been safeguarded over time. For example, the Convention on the Rights of the Child, the most universally ratified human rights convention in history, requires nations to examine and update their laws, policies, and institutions regarding child labor. Furthermore, the Convention on the Rights of the Child developed an enforcement and monitoring system, which is monitored by the UN Committee on the Rights of the Child. In addition to the Convention on the Rights of the Child, the International Labor Organization has created initiatives and cooperative programs. The International Programme for the Elimination of Child Labor was established in 1992, and it aims to gradually eradicate child labor by strengthening nations' capacity to tackle the issue and by fostering a global campaign against child labor. However, even in the twenty-first century, child labor is still one of the most pressing and significant human rights issues the global society is facing today.

It is a well-known fact that child labor interferes with children's essential rights that must be protected. Among the fundamental rights, the most common one is the right to receive education. By denying children their chance to receive education and forcing them to balance going to school with unduly demanding and time-consuming work, their right to proper education is ignored. Despite the above-mentioned international treaties made by nearly 193 United Nations member states, according to the ILO (International Labor Organization) and UNICEF (United Nations National Children's Fund)'s latest report, approximately 138 million children worldwide are still involved in child labor, which accounts for approximately 7.8% of all children worldwide. Many nations still lack the ability or political will to impose strong protections, even after decades of international agreements. The analysis from the UCLA Fielding School of Public Health revealed that 41 countries do not actively protect children under the age of 18 from performing dangerous tasks. For instance, almost 2.1 million children in the Ivory Coast and Ghana work on labor related to cocoa farms. It includes hazardous

tasks such as using sharp tools, applying chemicals, working days and nights that harm children's health and safety. Not only Ivory Coast and Ghana, but also nations such as Nigeria, Indonesia, Russia, Mexico, and Zimbabwe do not have strict laws against child labor, and even with their existing laws, loopholes exist that block strong restrictions on child labor.

The consequences of child labor are normally far more severe than simply depriving children of education and a healthy childhood. The prevalence of child labor often leads to children becoming victims of trafficking, further exacerbating the issue. Child labor persists due to its low cost and ease of control. Since children are forced to work silently for minimal pay, their vulnerability makes them easier to manage, continuing to fuel the demand for child labor. To satisfy the demand of industries and factories that rely on child labor, traffickers illegally exploit and traffic children. This creates a vicious cycle in which child labor and child trafficking feed on one another.

As with child labor, the victims of child trafficking suffer from disastrous physical and mental pain, such as severe trauma-related disorders, extreme anxiety, and depression. Victims also frequently feel difficulties in social integration since they can't fully develop cognitive and socio-emotional abilities. According to an explanation of child trafficking by UNODC (United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime), compared to victims of grown-ups, children are almost twice as likely to experience serious harm because children are still in the process of development. Over the past 15 years, from 2010 to 2025, the proportion of children among detected victims has tripled. Based on data reported by the United Nations Country Team in Thailand, children account for nearly 35% of all victims of human trafficking. However, the actual rate can be much higher because of the major obstacles affecting reporting and detection. The UNODC reports that 60% of all detected child victims are from Central America and the Caribbean, Sub-Saharan Africa, and North Africa. South and East Asia, the Pacific, and Europe all involve substantial percentages; therefore, this indicates that no region is perfectly immune to child trafficking.

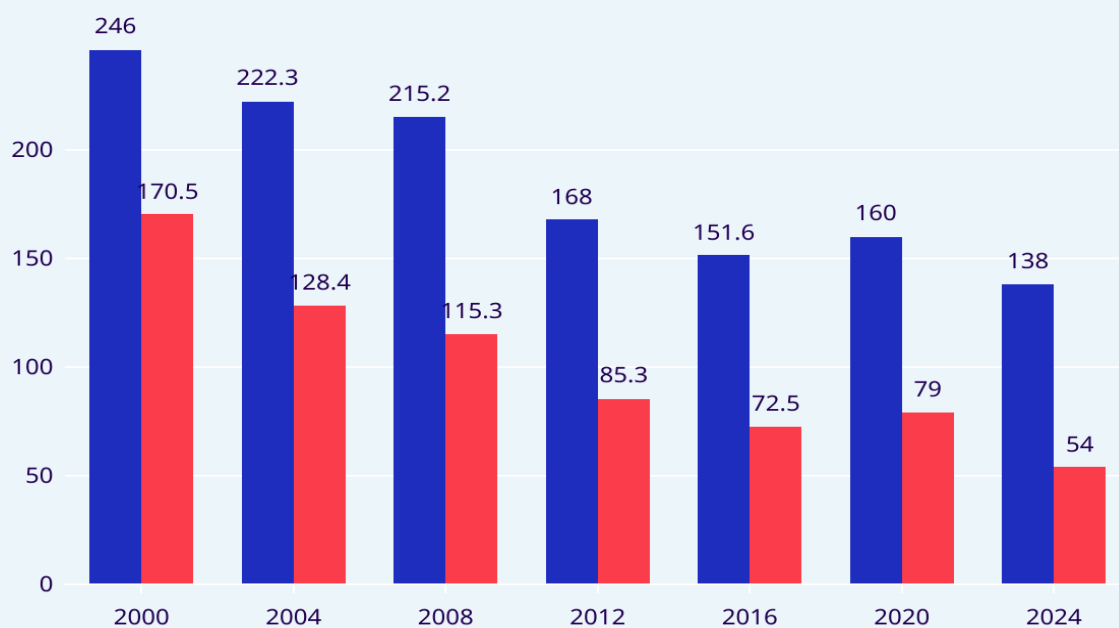


Child Trafficking and Child Exploitation Rate Worldwide (Terre des Hommes Netherlands Focus Brief, 2024)

To end the cycle of child labor and child trafficking, numerous global efforts have been employed. According to the global estimates of child labor by the ILO and UNICEF, the total number of children in child labor has nearly halved from 246 million to 138 million since 2000. While it is true that the overall child labor rate has declined, the rate of decline is extremely slow. Consequently, despite its positive trend, the global society failed to achieve SDGs (Sustainable Development Goals) 8.7, which calls for the eradication of child labor in all its forms by 2025. In May 2025, the United Nations held a “Childhood and Dignity” meeting where the participants admitted that it’s nearly impossible to accomplish SDG 8.7 by 2025; thus, the UN, along with nations, should further concentrate on acute and strict legal frameworks to address child labor. The UN General Assembly President Philemon Yang, the host of the meeting, remarked that the global community must address the root causes of child labor and act with renewed urgency to guarantee every child’s right to live a life of dignity and opportunity.

Number (in millions) of children aged 5-17 years in child labour and hazardous work

■ Child labour ■ Hazardous work



Trends and the Road Forward (ILO and UNICEF: Child labor: Global estimates 2024, 2025)

Definition of Key Terms

Child Labor

Child labor is defined as any type of employment that harms a child under the age of 18—physically, mentally, socially, or morally—and deprives them of their rights as a youth, future potential, and dignity. International standards define child labor as work that is hazardous to a child's health and development, demands too many hours, or is performed by children who are too young. ILO (International Labor Organization) suggests a minimum age for child labor rather than a specific standard with a minimum wage. The ILO Convention 138 sets the minimum age for a child at 15, but it can be 14 in countries with less developed economies and educational systems. This age limit applies only to light work that does not interfere with children's fundamental rights, education, and well-being, and doesn't include detrimental tasks. Whereas hazardous tasks for all children under 18 are prohibited in Convention 182.

Specifically in the US, a standard is established by the Fair Labor Standards Act, or FLSA. Children under the age of 14 are not permitted to work in non-agricultural occupations. Only non-manufacturing, non-mining, and non-hazardous jobs are available to 14 and 15-year-olds. Additionally, they are only permitted to work 18 hours during school weeks and 40 hours during non-school weeks. Work cannot start earlier than 7 a.m. or finish later than 7 p.m. Although each state has its child labor regulations, the FLSA serves as a foundation and recommends more stringent guidelines.

Hazardous Child Labor

According to the ILO Convention No. 182, which specifically mentions the worst forms of child labor, hazardous child labor refers to children doing tasks that are highly likely to harm their health or pose a threat to their safety. In simpler terms, these are the worst forms of child labor, which can cause severe injuries or even lead to death. Among all industrial groupings, children engaged in hazardous work make up 9.9% of all child laborers between the ages of 5 and 17. Hazardous child labor forces children to work in dangerous conditions, such as being exposed to toxic chemicals, fumes, and fire. Furthermore, it also includes making them work excessively long hours and denying them access to basic necessities, to safe water, enough food, or proper sanitation facilities.

Agriculture, the top three most dangerous industries, has the largest rate of all hazardous child labor. In the manufacturing industry, children are forced to operate unsecured machinery, handle poisonous chemicals, such as glues, dyes, and heavy metals, and work long hours in plants with poor

ventilation. These illnesses cause long-term health harm, breathing issues, and injuries. Moreover, children who work in the fishing industry frequently work on boats or along the shore, where they take the risk of drowning, handle seafood in unsafe environments, lift heavy loads, and use sharp tools. Infections, chemical burns.

Child Trafficking

The illegal movement of children for the purpose of exploitation is clarified as child trafficking. In contrast to trafficking involving adults, any movement of children is classified as trafficking, even without the use of force, as children are unable to provide informed consent or make rational decisions regarding their own exploitation. Child trafficking is a severe crime worldwide as a form of modern slavery, since it's easy for vulnerable children who can't clearly judge situations.

Trafficker

An individual or a group that recruits or transfers trafficking victims is referred to as a trafficker. When it comes to child trafficking, traffickers are the criminals who utilize children's vulnerability and act as caretakers or recruiters for jobs with the purpose of tricking children into an exploitative situation. Their primary intent is to exploit children for financial gain, often through forced labor, sexual exploitation, or other abusive means.

Traffickers frequently use lies, manipulation, and false promises to attract children. For instance, traffickers often target regions affected by poverty or crisis. They may pose as organizations offering children and their families respectable work, access to education, or the promise of a better life. By pretending to be employers or humanitarian workers, these criminals are able to gain the trust of parents. Additionally, traffickers may use social media to gradually groom children by befriending them or even making them believe they are in a romantic relationship. Once trust is established, they lure the children into situations of sex or labor trafficking. In other cases, traffickers may resort to coercion or even kidnapping.

Exploitation

Exploitation is when someone uses another person for their personal gain. UNCRC (United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child) outlines children's rights to be protected from exploitation. Article 35 provides a precise definition of child exploitation, defining it as any act in which a child is injured, abused, or exploited by an individual for financial or private advantage. The unequal distribution of power is common among all types of child exploitation. When children

perform tasks or do favors for the person taking advantage of them, they will be compensated with a place to live, a position in a group. The favors demanded in exchange are usually manipulative.

Modern Slavery

The circumstances of child exploitation in child labor and trafficking are similar to historical slavery, which denies freedom and utilizes power against children for financial gain. Therefore, although modern slavery isn't an official legal term, it is used to highlight the extreme exploitation happening today. About 50 million individuals are living in modern slavery, and 28 million of those are in forced labor. According to the most recent Global Estimates of Modern Slavery, which were released by the International Labour Organization, International Organization for Migration, and Walk Free.

Domestic Servitude

Domestic Servitude operates through the forced performance of domestic tasks and other services under conditions of segregation within private homes. It's considered a form of human trafficking and a modern slavery system, and is prohibited by domestic and international protocols, such as the Trafficking in Persons Protection Act in the United States. In Haiti, young girls are often sent from rural areas to urban homes, where they are subjected to domestic child labor known as "Restavèk." While promised education and care, they are often forced to work and suffer abuse, often skipping school and performing hard labor.

Poverty Cycle

The vicious cycle of poverty involves a complex interplay of economic, social, and psychological factors, creating barriers to escaping poverty and perpetuating poverty over generations. It continuously leads children to be in an impoverished environment. According to Concern Worldwide, an international humanitarian organization that strives for a world free from poverty, in 2024, 712 million people worldwide are living in extreme poverty, and it has significantly increased since 2020 due to the impacts of COVID-19, conflicts, and climate change issues. The poverty cycle is closely linked to child labor, as extreme poverty often forces parents to send their children to work to supplement the family's total income, which then hinders children's education and development.

Debt Bondage

Debt bondage, also known as bonded labor or debt slavery, is a form of modern slavery where a person is forced to work to pay off the debt. Debt bondage in child labor is a severe violation of human rights that traps children in exploitative work conditions due to the family's debt. This is often linked to the vicious cycle of poverty, where impoverished families take loans and pledge their children to labor.

Background Information

Causes of Child Labor

One of the primary reasons for child labor is poverty. Families who are unable to pay for necessities like food, water, education, or medical care have no choice but to send their kids to work in order to help support the family. Estimates show that low-income nations have the highest rates of child labor. The percentage of children working varies from 26.2% in low-income nations to 9.0% in lower-middle-income countries, 4.9% in upper-middle-income countries, and 0.9% in high-income countries. Child labor and poverty are a vicious cycle that cannot be ended unless one is addressed. Poverty is considered the most prevalent cause as it is associated with other issues, such as low literacy, lack of employment opportunities, and many more. According to research by Qassim University, 82% of child laborers are working due to poverty. Specifically, based on the report from the MINTRAB (Ministerio de Trabajo y Previsión Social), a government institution monitoring labor relations in Guatemala, 350,000 children are in child labor. This makes up 20% of all children between 10 and 14 years. Guatemala's child labor issue is highly related to poverty since 59% of Guatemala's population is suffering from poverty. This economic hardship is the major factor driving children into the labor market at an early age. The primary reason for children's opportunities being restricted and having low literacy rates is a result of limited access to proper education, due to obstacles like school fees or instability of the region, which directly relates to poverty. This leads children to be left with no choice but risky labor.

Not only reasons derived from poverty, but climate change can also be one of the drivers. In rural areas, farmers who see their crops destroyed due to climate change have no other choice but to send their children out to work. According to the report "The Relations between climate change and child labor in agriculture" by the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations, the effects of natural disasters and climate change is one which is becoming of increasing concern. When crops are destroyed or farming land is ruined, families struggle to make a living and are more likely to send their children to work in neighbouring farms.

Furthermore, according to the ILO (International Labor Organization), children make up more than half of the total number of people left alone by war. These children are particularly vulnerable to

forms of exploitation, including child labor, due to an increase in economic shocks, a breakdown of social support, lack of education and basic services, and disruption of child protection services.

Causes of Child Trafficking

Poverty is not only a primary root of child labor but also a major cause of child trafficking. Vulnerable children who are at risk of being coerced into trafficking are the target of traffickers. For instance, constant migrants, who tend to live in poor conditions, are susceptible to human trafficking, even more so if they are children. According to UNICEF (United Nations Children's Fund), 36.1 million children were international migrants in 2018 alone, facing a high risk of being subjected to human trafficking.

A child from any background may be vulnerable to human trafficking, but children from low-education homes are far more vulnerable. One explanation for this is that they have less understanding of their legal rights. Additionally, the child and their family are more vulnerable to deception if they do not speak the language of the nation they are in, because without adequate conditions of education, language barriers happen.

In many developing countries, weak law enforcement is a major driver of child trafficking. According to the Corruption and Contemporary Forms of Slavery report from UNDP (United Nations Development Programme), public officials' active condoning or encouraging corruption enables the activities of traffickers. Cross-border cooperation is limited, enabling traffickers to move children into areas with weaker enforcement. Cultural acceptance of practices like child marriage or child domestic work further hides trafficking, while victims are often misclassified as criminals or illegal migrants. In politically unstable regions, the high profits from trafficking far outweigh the minimal risk of punishment, so it perpetuates the cycle.

Actions to Address Child Labor and Trafficking

As the cornerstone of global policy is international conventions, several treaties exist. UN Convention on the Rights of the Child, ILO's Convention No.138 on minimum age for work, and Convention No.182 on the worst forms of child labor. Countries adopting these conventions must enact national laws and policies, for example, minimum-age laws, free schooling, and social protection. In 2015, the world also enshrined the goal to end all child labor by 2025 in SDG Target 8.7 and to eliminate exploitation of children in SDG 16.2, though it ended up in failure.

International organizations launch major reports and programs for the elimination of child labor and trafficking. ILO and UNICEF jointly publish annual global estimates of child labor reports. The ILO's IPEC program supports national projects like ACCEL Africa, Myanmar PEC (Program on the Elimination of Child Labor), and organizes conferences – the 5th Global Conference on Child Labor in Durban in 2022 led to a “Durban Call to Action”. The ILO established the ‘World Day Against Child Labor’ in 2002 to draw attention to the global effects of child labor, unite groups to draw attention to the predicament of child laborers, and offer solutions to end it. Every year on June 12, people commemorate World Day Against Child Labor. On this day, people honor the young laborers who have been denied the childhood, education, and future they are entitled to, outweighing the minimal risk of punishment, perpetuating the cycle. UNODC issues biennial global Trafficking in Persons Reports and provides technical assistance for victims. A migration agency, IOM, partners with UNICEF and NGOs in joint statements and operational guides. In July 2024, IOM, Save the Children, and UNICEF called for concerted efforts to combat child trafficking in Africa, emphasizing prevention and community protection mechanisms.

Challenges Fighting Against Child Labor and Child Trafficking

Child work is encouraged in large part by cultural ideas. In developing nations, employment is believed to help children improve their skills and build their character. In these households, it is customary for children to learn the job from an early age and follow in their parents' footsteps. Certain cultural ideas lead to the misconception that a girl's education is less significant than a boy's, which leads to the exploitation of girls as domestic workers. In South Sudan, for example, the Sudan Relief Fund has reported that only 8% of women can read. The main cause is that girls are frequently recognized and treated as collateral assets of a family. For instance, a family may be given cattle for the marriage dowry. This encourages the family to arrange their daughter's marriage as soon as possible, reducing the girl's chance to receive an education and leading her to become a domestic worker. When a child is not employed in developing nations, the family will not earn enough money to live comfortably. Child labor can be attributed to social and cultural factors, including prejudice and cultural biases against girls.

Additionally, data gaps and fragmented data analysis hinder efforts to prevent and respond to child trafficking since there is a lack of consistent data collection across areas and stakeholders, as well as difficulties in harmonizing data from various sources at the national level. Inadequate coordination amongst important players, including social services, immigration officials, and law enforcement, further compromises the accuracy and comprehensiveness of data. Certain kid groups are rendered invisible in data gathering attempts due to a lack of discovery. For example, children who

have been trafficked and are in residential care institutions may not be included in data collection efforts, making them entirely absent. Evidence from the European refugee and migrant response shows that girls may be misclassified as belonging to family groups, concealing their increased vulnerability to sexual abuse and human trafficking under what may seem like "protective" arrangements on the outside.

On the other hand, even individual beliefs can sometimes pose a barrier to resolving this issue. Despite the numerous national and international laws against child labor, people will still make excuses for it. Without children's additional financial contribution, some contend that impoverished families would be in a worse financial situation. Their survival rate will drop if they are unable to afford the necessities of food and shelter through the child's contribution. Furthermore, a rise in poverty would enhance children's vulnerability to exploitation. Those who accept these beliefs contend that, in some circumstances, it is needed to permit children to labor. They admit that as long as it doesn't interfere with children's fundamental rights and they have safe working conditions for a set number of hours each day, children working shouldn't be completely banned. Therefore, there is a need to discuss the degree of acceptable labor.

Corruption and weak government implementation of laws severely impede the fight against child labor and trafficking by creating environments where exploitation flourishes and legal protections fail. This allows criminal networks to operate with impunity, as corrupt officials may even be complicit with traffickers, accepting bribes and providing information. Inadequate legal frameworks and insufficient enforcement, often due to a lack of resources, training, or commitment, mean that existing laws designed to protect children are frequently not implemented effectively. The absence of proper government services further exacerbates this vulnerability, leaving countless children without protection.

Armed conflicts and displacement also significantly increase the risk of child labor and trafficking by disrupting political, legal, and social stability. Displaced populations, especially women and children, become highly vulnerable targets for exploitation due to the chaos and insecurity of conflict zones and migration routes. Children face grave violations in these settings, including recruitment into combat, sexual violence, and abduction, which often precede or accompany trafficking.

Possible Solutions

Establishing International Legal Frameworks

To eradicate child labor and child trafficking, international legal frameworks and enforcement must be strengthened. International conventions like the ILO Worst Forms of Child Labor and the ILO Minimum Age Conventions should be adopted and strictly enforced by all countries. Establishing an international minimum working age to make child labor and trafficking a crime will provide the legal foundation for actions. The legal gaps can be filled by all nations bringing their national legislation into alignment with these standards. Strict punishments for violators are needed, and an end to the exploitation of children. Children involved in those crimes mustn't be viewed as criminals but as victims.

Promoting Transparent Multinational Companies

Multinational companies increasing transparency with their workforce and payments can significantly combat child labor and trafficking by exposing hidden exploitation. Transparent reporting and risk assessment findings, including in supply chains, help illuminate areas where child labor might exist, driving accountability. For example, the California Transparency in Supply Chains Act requires companies to disclose efforts to eradicate forced labor and human trafficking, encouraging greater oversight. This transparency can lead to companies tracing their full supply chains, including informal and subcontracted tiers, which are often where child labor is most prevalent.

Providing More Incentives for Companies

Providing more incentives for companies that offer legal work in high-risk sectors like agriculture, mining, and textiles can also be a powerful solution. Current agricultural labor protections are often lax, allowing children as young as 12 to work with parental consent, and even younger on exempt farms, making incentives for legal work crucial. Incentives can encourage businesses to prioritize value creation and ethical practices more than immediate cost benefits, discontinuing the use of child labor.

Conducting Cooperative Partnership Programs

Active and cooperative operations across borders, training in specialized teams, and exchanging each capacity should be conducted. A good example, a joint INTERPOL operation involving 25 nations in the Americas, resulted in the arrest of 134 individuals, the rescue of almost 2,700 victims of human trafficking, and the break-up of seven organized crime groups. This shows that criminals can be punished when countries cooperate by sharing intelligence and working together.

Providing an Opportunity for Education

Ensuring citizens with social safety and high-quality education is a key solution. Children who go to school and have their basic needs met are less likely to be involved in exploitation. The financial incentive for child labor would directly decrease if policies made education more affordable and accessible. It can include a free offer of uniforms, scholarships, and free lunch. The lack of education leads children to be vulnerable to forced labor; therefore, handling the root cause is important.

Organizing Financial Support Programs

Global society must work together on financial programs to reduce poverty. According to a report from UNICEF and ILO, regular financial assistance for low-income households would raise attendance at school and decrease poverty, which then lowers child labor. The Bolsa Família conditional financial program in Brazil is a great example. It gives low-income families help if they satisfy a specific condition, which is children's attendance at school. Based on the Brazilian Institute of Geography and Statistics, school attendance significantly increased as a result of this initiative, and the number of children involved in child labor decreased. Social and financial aid and protection will surely reduce the rate of child labor and trafficking.

Running Global Campaigns and raising awareness

Global campaigns that extend business chains, educational programs, and media have international effects. Campaigns raise awareness among citizens, governments, and non-governmental organizations. It emphasizes the seriousness and encourages working together to invest in victims'

assistance, underlying the causes of child labor and trafficking. International campaigns are the first step to grab the attention of the global society. Global campaigns possess great potential, as it is proven by several instances. Live Aid, for example, was a campaign in the form of a concert on July 13, 1985. It aimed to raise financial aid for the relief of famine-stricken nations in Africa. It attracted people's attention and, as a result, Live Aid earned over 245 million dollars and raised awareness of the famine.

Major parties involved

ILO (International Labor Organization)

The United Nations (UN) has a specialized body called the International Labor Organization (ILO) that works to raise living standards and labor conditions. It leads the multi-stakeholder Alliance 8.7 initiative, which aims to expedite progress toward SDG 8.7. The ILO has helped nations tighten laws and regulations, such as Conventions 182 and 138, through its IPEC (International Programme on the Elimination of Child Labor). On 20 May 2022, the ILO opened the 5th Global Conference on the Elimination of Child Labor, where the Durban Call to Action was adopted, encouraging urgent steps to end child labor by 2025, as Target 8.7 aims to. The ILO states that it's impossible to accomplish the goal of eradicating child labor by 2025; however, it actively calls for increased investment in social protections for children.

UNICEF (United Nations Children's Fund)

UNICEF is working to address the root causes and risk factors of child trafficking through a multi-sectoral approach that strengthens both systems and community resilience. In recent years, UNICEF has especially focused on emerging risks of child trafficking. In 2022, UNICEF released global guidance to help countries improve their legislative frameworks against abuse of children and sexual exploitation, in light of growing technology-facilitated trafficking. Across more than 150 countries, UNICEF supports programs to prevent child labor and trafficking and provides aid to survivors. UNICEF also supports conditional cash transfer programs. In Türkiye, for instance, a UNICEF-backed program provides regular payments to refugee families to keep children in school and out of labor.

United States of America

Lately, the United States has revised and broadened its legislation regarding child labor and child trafficking. The Abolish Trafficking Reauthorization Act of 2022, passed by Congress in January 2023, added additional anti-trafficking provisions and renewed important programs through 2027. The Center for Countering Human Trafficking (CCHT) of the Department of Homeland Security was formally founded in 2022 with more cash and staffing after President Biden signed the Countering Human Trafficking Act of 2021. Federal agencies have extensively pursued the fight

against child labor. For instance, a large food sanitation company that employed more than 100 juveniles in dangerous meatpacking occupations was fined \$1.5 million in 2023. Every year, U.S. law enforcement continues to pursue hundreds of cases in the fight against human trafficking. In terms of legislation, child rights groups are concerned about certain states' contentious efforts to relax child labor laws in non-hazardous occupations, even though federal protections are still robust. Since 2021, at least 12 states have passed such laws.

United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland

On the foundation of the Modern Slavery Act 2015, the United Kingdom continues to build policies to address child exploitation. On the child labor front domestically, the UK has strict laws prohibiting harmful child work, and reports of illegal child labor are not common. Instead, the UK's focus has been on child trafficking. The UK has increased international cooperation with countries like Vietnam, Nigeria, and Albania to crack down on child trafficking. All large UK businesses are required to report on steps to prevent slavery and child labor in their supply chain. The government launched an online registry of modern slavery statements, and by 2021, over 21,000 organizations had published statements, improving the transparency of child exploitation.

Federal Republic of Nigeria

Nigeria launched a revised National Policy on Child Labor and a National Action Plan for the Elimination of Child Labor, which aligns with SDG target 8.7. Nigeria is currently facing high burden of child labor in the world. The 2022 National Child Labor Survey revealed that about 50.5% of children in Nigeria aged 5 to 17 are engaged in some form of economic activity. Almost 39.2% are in child labor, and 22.9% are in hazardous work. The government's action of Universal Basic Education — free schooling to junior secondary — has improved enrollment rates, but Nigeria still has millions of students not attending school. More importantly, approximately 40.1% of Nigeria's population is in poverty. And as poverty is a major cause of child labor and trafficking, it makes Nigeria more vulnerable to those crimes. Nigeria reinforced its policies against child labor and trafficking in the last five years, yielding increased arrests, more children rescued, and greater awareness. However, vast numbers of children are still affected by child exploitation.

Timeline Of Events

Date	Description of event
<i>Geneva Declaration of the Child, adopted</i> November 1924	The first international charter of children's rights. It explicitly indicates that every child must be in a position to earn a livelihood and must be protected against every form of exploitation.
<i>ILO Minimum Age Convention (No.138)</i> <i>adopted, June 1973.</i>	Sets the minimum age for employment to ensure children are not denied their rights to education.
<i>Global March Against Child Labor Launched,</i> 1998	The grassroots movement for children's rights, known as the Global March Against Child Labor, began in January 1998, involving an 80,000km march through 103 countries, culminating in Geneva.
<i>Worst Forms of Child Labor Convention</i> <i>(No.182), June 1999</i>	Requires instant action against the worst forms of child labor.
<i>ILO launches 'World Day Against Child Labor',</i> 2002	The ILO instituted the first annual World Day against Child Labor on June 12, 2002. This aims to raise awareness and build a global movement to end child labor
<i>Alliance 8.7 launched, 2016</i>	To achieve Target 8.7 and end child labor and trafficking, ILO, UNICEF, and businesses launched a global multi-stakeholder collaboration. Alliance 8.7 coordinates international action and funding, aiming to eradicate the worst types of child labor by 2025 and all forms by 2030.

UN Involvement, Resolutions, Treaties, and Events

- ILO Minimum Age Convention (No.138) adopted, 26 June 1973. It requires nations to set a minimum age for employment and to institute national policies to prevent the violation of child labor. By setting legal work age and education, it establishes a global standard to prevent child exploitation.
- The UN treaty, the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child in 1989, guarantees children's rights. It recognizes every child's right to be protected from economic exploitation and forbids work that is hazardous or interferes with their education.
- ILO International Programme on the Elimination of Child Labor, launched in 1992, helps governments develop action plans, withdraw children from hazardous work, and conduct child-labour surveys. Under IPEC, hundreds of national programmes and new legislation have been funded, involving governments, employers, workers, and civil society.
- On 18 June 1998, the ILO adopted the Declaration on Fundamental Principles and Rights at Work for the fundamental obligation of child labor, even for those that have not ratified specific child labor conventions. It thus reinforced child labor elimination as an essential law.
- Worst Forms of Child Labor Convention (No.182), 17 June 1999, is a convention from the ILO, as a UN specialized body, that commits countries to take immediate, effective action to eliminate the worst forms of child labor, such as slavery, trafficking, and hazardous work.
- UN Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, adopted in 2002, especially emphasizes the prevention, prosecution, and protection of women and children and urges nations and UN agencies to integrate trafficking response into development and security efforts. In particular, it established a UN voluntary trust fund to aid victims of trafficking.
- General Assembly resolution A/RES/73/327 formally designates 2021 as a year to step up efforts to eradicate forced labour, end human trafficking, and secure the prohibition and elimination of the worst forms of child labour with a goal of ending child labour by 2025. It strengthens global commitments and helps create partnerships.
- The General Assembly Resolution A/RES/76/186 highlights emerging threats of human trafficking—especially the exploitation of women and children—facilitated by digital technologies. The main purpose is to strengthen national anti-trafficking efforts.

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